

Scratch for Parents: Learn It, Then Teach It

A gentle, hands-on workshop series for parents and caregivers with no coding experience. Over six evenings you learn Scratch yourself, practise teaching it through role-plays, build a real game with your child at Family Build Night, and graduate as their coding buddy.

FORMAT

Instructor-led

DURATION

6 sessions · 12 hrs

EACH SESSION

2 hours · 1 evening

LEVEL

**Beginner · no
coding**

SESSION SCHEDULE

Times assume a 6:30–8:30 pm evening. Every session opens with a check-in and journal share, has a 10-minute break, and closes with a journal entry and one thing to **try at home this week**. Each lesson has a **Teach-It** pair role-play: one grown-up plays the child from a kid card and the other coaches.

SESSION 1**Getting Started with Scratch**

By the end: meet Scratch, find your way around the editor, save a project, and make the cat move and talk.

EVENING Module 1 · Lessons 1.1–1.3

6:30–8:30

6:30 **Welcome, devices & accounts**
Mouse at every seat · open scratch.mit.edu → Create · account options · “why are you here?” icebreaker

6:45 **1.1** **What Is Scratch & Why Kids Love It**
Sprites, stage & blocks · Teach-It role-play: “the pitch” to your child

7:10 **1.2** **A Guided Tour of the Scratch Editor**
The four zones · “Point and Name” game · green flag & stop

7:28 *Break*

7:38 **1.2** **Saving, accounts & the offline app**
Save to your computer and reload · kid-account walkthrough · Teach-It: “the 60-second tour”

7:53 **1.3** **Your First Project: Make the Cat Move & Talk**
Live demo, block by block

8:01 **LAB** **Hands-on: cat move & talk, then “make it yours”**
[labs/module-1/l1-3-cat-move-talk.sb3](#) · Teach-It: “treasure hunt, not dictation”

8:20 **Wrap-up: journal & “try at home this week”**

SESSION 2

Core Coding Concepts

By the end: put blocks in the right order, repeat them with loops, and make choices with `if` and sensing.

EVENING Module 2 · Lessons 2.1–2.3

6:30–8:30

6:30 Check-in & journal share

6:40 Unplugged: “Program the Facilitator”
The room gives instructions; the facilitator follows them literally

6:50 **2.1** Sequences & Timing
Order changes behavior · pacing with *wait*

6:58 **LAB** **Hands-on:** greeting routine
l2-1-greeting-routine.sb3 · Teach-It: the robot game

7:13 **2.2** Loops: Making Things Repeat
repeat vs *forever* · inside vs outside the C

7:23 Break

7:33 **LAB** **Hands-on:** walking cat
l2-2-walking-cat.sb3 · Teach-It: spot-the-loop

7:50 **2.3** Conditionals & Sensing
Unplugged “If it’s raining, then...” · *forever* + *if* · if/then/else

8:03 **LAB** **Hands-on:** arrow-key cat
l2-3-arrow-key-cat.sb3 · Teach-It: coach with questions only

8:20 Wrap-up: quick-check round, journal & “try at home”

SESSION 3 Building Real Projects

By the end: stage an animated story, build a catch game with a score, and find and fix bugs calmly.

EVENING Module 3 · Lessons 3.1–3.3

6:30–8:30

6:30 Check-in & journal share

6:40 **3.1** An Interactive Animated Story
The x/y grid · *go to* vs *glide* · *broadcast* as stage director

6:52 **LAB** **Hands-on:** two-character conversation
l3-1-conversation.sb3 · Teach-It: “story before code”

7:08 **3.2** A Simple Game with Variables & Score
A variable is a whiteboard · make *score* · plan the game

7:20 Break

7:30 **LAB** **Hands-on:** Catch the Apple
l3-2-catch-the-apple.sb3 · Teach-It: “design first”

7:50 **3.3** Debugging & Remixing
The 4-step method · usual suspects · See Inside & remix

7:58 **LAB** **Bug Hunt:** four planted bugs, in pairs
l3-3-bug-hunt-starter.sb3 · Teach-It: “ask, don’t fix”

8:20 Wrap-up: Bug Hall of Fame, journal & “try at home”

SESSION 4

Clones & My Blocks

By the end: make many copies of one sprite with clones, build your own blocks, and get ready for Family Build Night.

EVENING Module 4 (part 1) · Lessons 4.1–4.2

6:30–8:30

6:30 Check-in & a first look at Star Catcher

6:40 **4.1** Clones: One Sprite, Many Copies
The hidden “stamp” · *create clone of* · cleaning up clones

6:55 **LAB** **Hands-on:** falling stars
l4-1-falling-stars.sb3 · Teach-It role-play + check

7:20 *Break*

7:30 **4.2** My Blocks: Make Your Own Blocks
Custom blocks with and without inputs · *reset game*

7:42 **LAB** **Hands-on:** jump, dance & reset game
l4-2-my-blocks.sb3 · Teach-It role-play + check

8:05 Family Build Night briefing
The Game Design Card · director and typist roles · RSVPs

8:20 Wrap-up · **homework:** fill in the Game Design Card with your child

SESSION 5

Family Build Night

By the end: build **Star Catcher** together, with your child directing and you typing only when asked.

KIDS ATTEND Module 4 (part 2) · Capstone 4.3–4.4

6:30–8:30

6:30	Arrival & kid-friendly opening Name tags · play the finished game · “Tonight you’re the boss”
6:40	The rules & the Game Design Card
6:45	CAP Capstone Part 1: plan it & build the core (4.3) Steps 1–7 from the projector · l4-3-star-catcher-part1.sb3 is the rescue file
7:30	Checkpoint: smallest playable version Everyone plays one round and saves
7:35	<i>Break: snacks & try other families’ games</i>
7:45	CAP Capstone Part 2: lives, Game Over & tuning (4.4) l4-4-star-catcher-final.sb3 · Project Completion checklist
8:15	Launch day mini-showcase Kids explain their rules, then hand off and watch
8:25	Wrap-up & applause round

SESSION 6 Teaching Scratch to Your Child

By the end: coach without taking over, set up safe sharing, start a young child on ScratchJr, pick a next step, and celebrate.

EVENING Module 5 · Lessons 5.1–5.4 + graduation

6:30–8:30

6:30 Check-in: Family Build Night stories

6:40 **5.1** The Art of Not Taking Over
Scaffolding · ask, don't tell · process praise & “yet” · hands-off coaching rounds

7:00 **5.2** Sharing Safely & the Scratch Community
Private by default · safety checklist · family sharing rules

7:18 Break

7:28 **5.3** ScratchJr: Coding for Ages 5–7
Build “My Pet Says Hi” · coach a 5-year-old (role-play)

7:45 **5.4** What Comes After Scratch
The road map · blocks to Python · plan your next project

7:55 Final journal & course evaluation
Children arrive and settle

8:05 **CAP** **Showcase & graduation:** children present their games
Kind-comment gallery · certificates

COURSE DETAILS

■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **None.** No coding or “tech” experience needed. Absolute beginners are welcome.
- ◆ Able to open a website and click, drag, and type
- ◆ A laptop or Chromebook, its charger, and a **mouse** (strongly recommended for drag-and-drop)
- ◆ A current web browser: Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari
- ◆ A child aged about 5–16 to teach is helpful, but not required

■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **setup guide** to finish before Session 1 (about 10 minutes)
- ◆ The **participant workbook** for all 17 lessons, with a learning journal (yours to keep)
- ◆ **Reference Scratch projects** for every lab, plus a “rescue file” for Family Build Night
- ◆ Teach-It role-play **kid cards**, a family safety checklist, and the Game Design Card
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: rays-scratch.netlify.app

■ Family Build Night

- ◆ **Session 5 is for families.** Bring your child (about ages 5–12). No child available? You'll pair up with another grown-up.
- ◆ Your child is the **director** and you're the **typist**: you code only when asked
- ◆ Session 4 homework: fill in the **Game Design Card** together, in your child's words
- ◆ Children come back for the last 25 minutes of **Session 6** to present their games and see you graduate

■ Alternative: 3 Saturdays

- ◆ The same six sessions run as **three Saturday half-days** (two sessions each, with lunch between)
- ◆ **Saturday 1:** Sessions 1 + 2 · Getting Started, Core Concepts
- ◆ **Saturday 2:** Sessions 3 + 4 · Real Projects, Clones & My Blocks
- ◆ **Saturday 3:** Session 5 (Family Build Night, kids attend) + Session 6, with kids back for the showcase
- ◆ The week between Saturdays 2 and 3 is when families fill in the Game Design Card

What You'll Be Able to Do

Graduates leave able to build in Scratch **and** to sit beside their child as a confident coding buddy.

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|--|--|
| ✓ Find your way around the Scratch editor and save your work | ✓ Make sprites move, talk, and react with events and sequences |
| ✓ Use loops, conditionals, and sensing to control behavior | ✓ Keep score and lives with variables |
| ✓ Build a real game with clones, My Blocks, and broadcasts | ✓ Find and fix bugs with a calm 4-step method |
| ✓ Coach your child without taking over the mouse | ✓ Set up safe sharing, start ages 5–7 on ScratchJr, and plan what comes next |

Companion course, free online: rays-scratch.netlify.app. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation; this course is independent and not affiliated with or endorsed by the Scratch Foundation or MIT.